Faq Troubleshooting

When a SWAT+ run does not produce what you expect, the first three files to read are `simulation.out`, `diagnostics.out`, and `checker.out`. Their format is described in Checker and diagnostics.

Pages

- Common runtime errors. The error strings the model writes to its diagnostic files, what they mean, and what to change.
- Water balance and mass balance issues. When `basin_wb_aa.txt` looks wrong: climate mapping, curve numbers, missing management, bad soils.
- Performance tips. Build flags, daily versus sub-daily routing, the cost of enabling many outputs.

When in doubt

1. Confirm the executable matches the input format. Use the SWAT+ revision printed on the first line of `simulation.out`.
2. Read `diagnostics.out` end to end. Every line is a missing reference that SWAT+ replaced with a default or skipped.
3. Read `checker.out`. The per-HRU `zmx`, `sumfc`, `sumul`, `tiledrain` columns are the fastest way to spot a soil or option that did not load.
4. Confirm `success.fin` exists. If it does not, the run aborted.